

Advanced Imaging Utilization Management Policy - 2026

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SECTION 1: PURPOSE

This policy defines utilization-management requirements for advanced diagnostic imaging, including MRI, CT, PET and selected advanced imaging studies.

SECTION 2: AUTHORIZATION REQUIREMENT

Prior authorization is required for non-emergency outpatient advanced diagnostic imaging when the member's benefit plan lists the service on the authorization schedule. The request must be approved before the scheduled service date.

SECTION 3: CLINICAL INFORMATION

Requests should include the clinical indication, relevant history, prior conservative treatment where applicable, prior imaging results when relevant and the ordering provider's requested study.

SECTION 4: EMERGENCY AND INPATIENT EXCEPTIONS

Advanced imaging performed during an emergency department encounter is not subject to prior authorization. Imaging performed during an authorized inpatient admission does not require a separate outpatient imaging authorization.

SECTION 5: CONTRAST

When contrast is clinically appropriate for an authorized imaging study, contrast administration is reviewed as part of the imaging request and does not require a separate authorization unless the member plan explicitly states otherwise.

SECTION 6: DECISION COMMUNICATION

Authorization decisions are communicated to the requesting provider. A denial notice includes the applicable reason and available review or appeal options.

Training note: This document is synthetic and created only for AI/RAG training.